



UNITED STATES
NUCLEAR REGULATORY COMMISSION
REGION III
2056 WESTINGS AVENUE, SUITE 400
NAPERVILLE, IL 60563-2657

September 2, 2025

Mike Mlynarek
Site Vice President
Palisades Energy, LLC
27780 Blue Star Memorial Highway
Covert, MI 49043

SUBJECT: PALISADES NUCLEAR PLANT - EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS BIENNIAL
EXERCISE INSPECTION REPORT 05000255/2025501

Dear Mike Mlynarek:

On July 31, 2025, the U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC) completed an inspection at Palisades Nuclear Plant and discussed the results of this inspection with you and other members of your staff. The results of this inspection are documented in the enclosed report.

No violations were identified during this inspection.

On June 13, 2022, Palisades ceased permanent power operations and subsequently removed all fuel from the reactor, as detailed in the letter from Entergy to the NRC, "Certifications of Permanent Cessation of Power Operations and Permanent Removal of Fuel from the Reactor Vessel," (ADAMS Accession No. ML22164A067). On September 28, 2023, Holtec Decommissioning International, LLC (Holtec) submitted a letter to the NRC requesting exemptions from certain portions of the requirements of Title 10 of the *Code of Federal Regulations* (10 CFR) 50.82(a)(2) to pursue the potential reauthorization of power operations at Palisades (ADAMS Accession No. ML23271A140). On July 24, 2025, the NRC approved an exemption from the requirements of 10 CFR 50.82(a)(2), as detailed in the letter, "Palisades Nuclear Plant - Exemption from the Requirements of 10 CFR 50.82(a)(2) Concerning the Prohibition to Operate and Emplace Fuel in the Reactor Vessel," (ADAMS Accession No. ML25163A182).

This letter, its enclosure, and your response (if any) will be made available for public inspection and copying at <http://www.nrc.gov/reading-rm/adams.html> and at the NRC Public Document Room in accordance with Title 10 of the *Code of Federal Regulations* 2.390, "Public Inspections, Exemptions, Requests for Withholding."

Sincerely,



Kutlesa, Jure signing on behalf
of Ziolkowski, Michael
on 09/02/25

Michael E. Ziolkowski, Chief
Security, Emergency Preparedness, and Incident
Response Branch
Division of Radiological Safety and Security

Docket No. 05000255
License No. DPR-20

Enclosure:
As stated

cc w/ encl: Distribution via LISTSERV

Letter to M. Mlynarek from M. Ziolkowski dated September 2, 2025.

SUBJECT: PALISADES NUCLEAR PLANT - EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS BIENNIAL
EXERCISE INSPECTION REPORT 05000255/2025501

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U.S. NUCLEAR REGULATORY COMMISSION
Inspection Report

Docket Number: 05000255

License Number: DPR-20

Report Number: 05000255/2025501

Enterprise Identifier: I-2025-501-0011

Licensee: Palisades Energy, LLC

Facility: Palisades Nuclear Plant

Location: Covert, MI

Inspection Dates: July 28, 2025, to July 31, 2025

Inspectors: B. Jebbia, Operations Engineer
J. Kutlesa, Sr Emergency Preparedness Inspector
T. McGowan, Emergency Preparedness Inspector
K. Miller, Emergency Preparedness Specialist
J. Quichocho, Branch Chief
V. Myers, Sr Health Physicist
J. Winslow, Sr Project Engineer

Approved By: Michael E. Ziolkowski, Chief
Security, Emergency Preparedness, and Incident Response Branch
Division of Radiological Safety and Security

Enclosure

SUMMARY

The U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC) performed inspections of the licensee's readiness to restart by conducting an emergency preparedness biennial exercise inspection at Palisades Nuclear Plant.

List of Findings and Violations

No violations were identified.

Additional Tracking Items

None.

INSPECTION SCOPES

Inspections were conducted using the appropriate portions of the inspection procedures (IPs) in effect at the beginning of the inspection unless otherwise noted. Currently approved IPs with their attached revision histories are located on the public website at <http://www.nrc.gov/reading-rm/doc-collections/insp-manual/inspection-procedure/index.html>. The inspectors reviewed selected procedures and records, observed activities, and interviewed personnel to assess licensee performance and compliance with Commission rules and regulations, license conditions, site procedures, and standards.

REACTOR SAFETY

71114.01 - Exercise Evaluation

Exercise Evaluation (1 Sample)

- (1) The inspectors evaluated the biennial emergency plan exercise and evaluated emergency plan performance on July 29, 2025. The exercise scenario simulated an event at the Palisades Nuclear Plant that initiated with the declaration and notification of an Alert caused by a failure of the Reactor Protection System automatic trip when a Primary Coolant Pump experienced a rapid increase in vibration and tripped on overcurrent. The scenario conditions simulated the escalation of the significance of the event, requiring the declaration of a Site Area Emergency and a General Emergency which was communicated to the required state and local government agencies.

The inspectors observed and evaluated the exercise at the site's emergency response facilities, including the Control Room Simulator, the Technical Support Center, the Operations Support Center, and the Emergency Operations Facility.

The inspectors observed that some Emergency Preparedness Implementing Procedures (EPIPs) were not consistent with the Site Emergency Plan. For example, the Technical Support Center (TSC) minimum staffing in the Emergency Plan states that minimum staffing to activate the TSC is 9 personnel. The TSC Activation Procedure (EI-4.1) is unclear in defining minimum staffing requirements. During the exercise the licensee staffed the TSC to the Emergency Plan required minimum staffing. The licensee entered this issue into their corrective action program as CR 25011215. The NRC will inspect this issue during a future program/baseline inspection.

The inspectors observed that the Emergency Response Data System (ERDS) was activated during the exercise, however data transmission to the NRC was not functioning. The licensee entered this issue into their corrective action program as CR 25006740. The NRC will inspect this issue during a future program/baseline inspection.

During the inspection, the inspectors verified the licensee has developed and is implementing an emergency preparedness program that effectively protects the public health and safety. The inspectors familiarized themselves with relevant documentation which may include but is not limited to the licensee's emergency plan and site-specific and/or corporate implementing procedures.

The inspectors reviewed the licensee plans:

- for a standard emergency classification and action level scheme, the bases of which include facility system and effluent parameters, is in use by the nuclear facility licensee, and State and local response plans call for reliance on information provided by facility licensees for determinations of minimum initial offsite response measures;
- that procedures have been established for notification, by the licensee, of State and local response organizations and for notification of emergency personnel by all organizations; the content of initial and follow-up messages to response organizations and the public has been established;
- that adequate methods, systems, and equipment for assessing and monitoring actual or potential offsite consequences of a radiological emergency condition are in use;
- that a range of protective actions has been developed for the plume exposure pathway EPZ for emergency workers and the public. In developing this range of actions, consideration has been given to evacuation, sheltering, and, as a supplement to these, the prophylactic use of potassium iodide (KI), as appropriate. Evacuation time estimates have been developed by the licensee. Guidelines for the choice of protective actions during an emergency, consistent with Federal guidance, are developed and in place, and protective actions for the ingestion exposure pathway EPZ appropriate to the locale have been developed.

The inspectors also conducted a review of past emergency preparedness inspection reports for the facility, to a level which provides assurance that the licensee is meeting or prepared to meet the NRC regulatory requirements within the emergency preparedness program area being inspected.

71114.08 - Exercise Evaluation - Scenario Review

Exercise Evaluation - Scenario Review (1 Sample)

- (1) The inspectors reviewed and evaluated the proposed scenario for biennial emergency plan exercise on June 11, 2025.

INSPECTION RESULTS

No violations were identified.

EXIT MEETINGS AND DEBRIEFS

The inspectors verified no proprietary information was retained or documented in this report.

- On July 31, 2025, the inspectors presented the emergency preparedness biennial exercise inspection results to Mike Mlynarek and other members of the licensee staff.

DOCUMENTS REVIEWED

Inspection Procedure	Type	Designation	Description or Title	Revision or Date
71114.01	Corrective Action Documents	PAL-06740, CR 25006740	ERDS Connection to Existing PPC	04/30/2025
	Corrective Action Documents Resulting from Inspection	25011215	NRC Observation During Graded Exercise	08/13/2015
	Procedures	EI-4.1	Technical Support Center Activation	Draft
		EI-4.2	Operations Support Center Activation	Draft
		HDI PNP 2022-032	Palisades Nuclear Plant 2022 Evacuation Time Estimate Report	09/07/2022
		KLD TR – 24-1447	Palisades Power Plant 2023 Population Update Analysis	08/31/2023
		KLD TR – 24-1448	Palisades Power Plant 2024 Population Update Analysis	08/30/2024
		PNP SEP 04.07.2025	Palisades Nuclear Plant Site Emergency Plan	Draft
		SEP Supp 1	Site Emergency Plan Supplement 1 - EAL Wall Charts	05/31/2018
71114.08	Miscellaneous	PNP 2025-044	Updated 2025 Palisades Nuclear Plant Emergency Exercise Scenario	06/30/2025